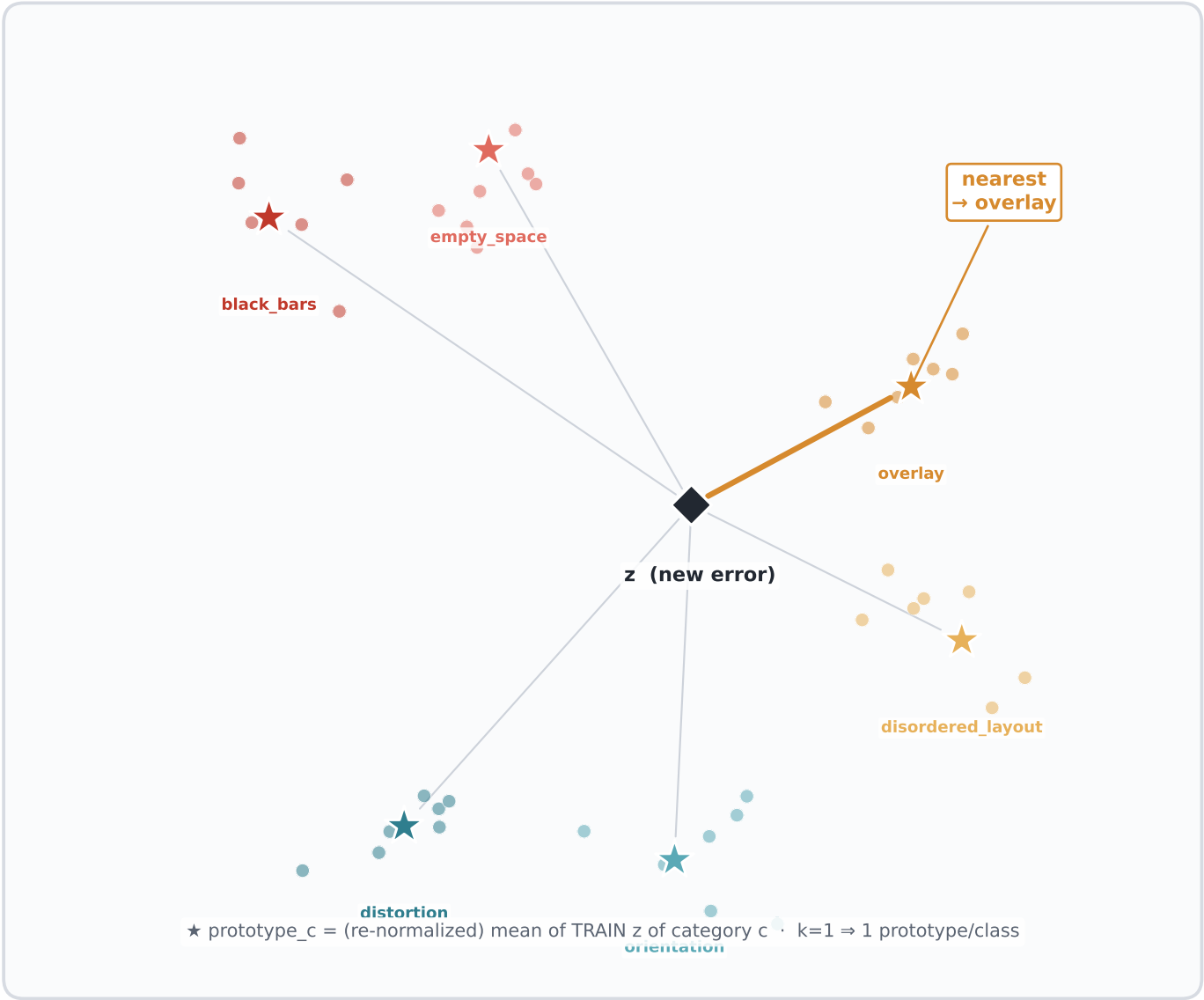


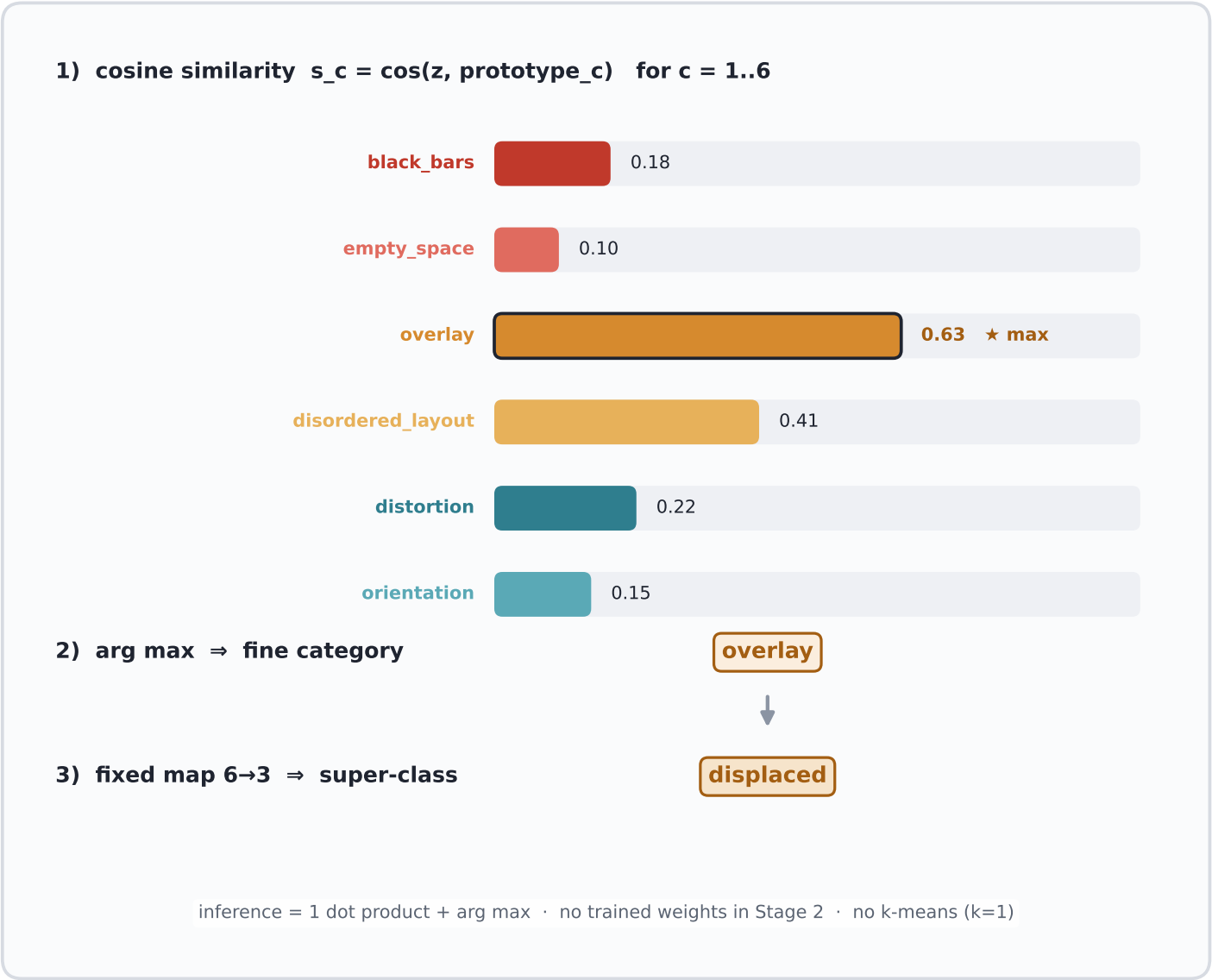
Stage 2 — how the category is computed

“nearest category prototype” (nearest-centroid) in z-space — reuses the SAME z from Stage 1, no new network and no MLP decider

(a) in z-space: the nearest prototype



(b) the computation, step by step



Reuses the SAME z from Stage 1 · no network/siamese applied again · the aux head (MLP 128→7) is DIAGNOSTIC only, doesn't decide · separation = nearest-centroid in SupCon's z